

HASHKAMA



פרשת בהעלותך

כ' סיון תשפ"ו

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WEEKLY

By Reb Gemini חכמה ב-אI תאמין?

Consider the following "Torah" thought, generated by Gemini:
Did the AI get it right?

Do you find

it to be accurate?

Or did the technology miss the boat?

In the beginning of Parshas Behaaloscha, Rashi (Bamidbar 8:2) cites a Midrash Tanchuma that Aharon Hakohen experienced a deep feeling of chashidas hadaas following the chanukas hamizbeach. Every Nasi had brought a magnificent korban, while Shevet Levi sat completely on the sidelines. To console him, Hashem tells him, "Shelcha gedolah mishelahem," granting Aharon the daily mitzvah of the Hadlakas Hamenorah. Now, a Litvak might ask a klotz kashe: if Aharon is the Kohen Gadol running the avodah all day long, why was he suddenly struck with intense FOMO like a guy who didn't get a Shishi on Shabbos Mevarchim? The Sfas Emes (Behaaloscha, Tar'ma) explains that Aharon was not looking for a photo-op; rather, he recognized that the Nesi'im infused the Mishkan with an eternal, spontaneous mesiras nefesh that a structured, mandatory daily chiyuv might lack. Aharon desperately wanted that fresh, unscripted spark. Hashem responded that by lighting the Menorah—doing the exact same routine avodah every single day without losing an ounce of bren—that relentless consistency is actually a much greater display of mesiras nefesh than a one-time grand gesture, no matter how expensive the korban. We see this exact theme of enduring consistency perfectly mirrored later in the Parshah regarding the Chatzotzros. The Torah (Bamidbar 10:2) commands Moshe Rabbeinu to craft two silver trumpets, specifically instructing that they must be a mikshah achas, sharing the precise structural requirement of the Menorah (Rashi Bamidbar 8:4). The Ramban (Bamidbar 10:2) points out that these Chatzotzros were absolutely essential for gathering the Eidah and directing the machaneh during their travels. Why must they be a mikshah achas? Because true leadership and genuine avodas Hashem cannot be hastily pieced together from leftover fragments of inspiration and duct-tape enthusiasm. The Kli Yakar (Bamidbar 10:2) notes that the word Chatzotzros hints at chatzi tzuros. You might have the elite Kohen Gadol on one side and a pashute Yid on the other, but they must both remain intrinsically connected as one unified entity. The conceptual connection between Aharon's Menorah and Moshe's Chatzotzros is profound: you simply cannot sustain the tzibur with a fractured foundation. Just as Aharon brought a steady, unyielding flame every morning that never flickered from its original solid source, Moshe's silver trumpets had to ring out with a singular, unbroken voice to unite a very diverse, and occasionally quite stubborn, Klal Yisrael. The **practical takeaway** for our own avodah is glaringly obvious, especially when we drag ourselves into the Beis Midrash for Shacharis on a bleak, rainy Tuesday morning. We all love the massive, exciting korbanos of the Nesi'im—the roaring Yomim Noraim davening, the massive siyum, the heavily catered fleishig Kiddush with extra cholent. But Hashem tells Aharon, and by extension every single one of us, that "shelcha gedolah mishelahem." The real mikshah achas of a Yid is forged in the daily, unglamorous grind. When you show up day in and day out, hammered by the intense stress of parnassah and daily life, yet you still manage to light your personal Menorah with the very same kavana as the first day, that is the ultimate shleimus. We must actively strive to be a mikshah achas—not Jewish by a flimsy, convenient patchwork, but deeply, thoroughly consistent, making sure our daily routine rings just as loud and clear as those silver Chatzotzros.

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Shabbus Zmanim

Chestnut Ridge, NY

2:30 pm	מנחה
6:52/8:07 pm	הדלקה (Early/Late)
--- pm	מנחה - קבלת שבת
8:25 pm	שקיעה
3:36/4:12 am	עלות השחר (16.1/72)
5:24 am	נץ החמה
7:15 am	שחרית
Hot kiddush & Shiur after davening	
8:34/9:10 am	סיור קריאת שמע
10:01/10:25 am	סיור תפילה
12:55 pm	חצות היום
1:33 pm	מנחה גדולה (גר"א)
5:18 pm	מנחה קטנה (גר"א)
6:52 pm	פלג המנחה (גר"א)
--- pm	מנחה
8:26 pm	שקיעה
9:16/9:16 pm	צה"כ ר' משה (8.5/50)
9:18 pm	מעריב (52)
9:26/9:38 pm	צה"כ (60/72)



Next Week's Zmanim

Chestnut Ridge, NY

2:30 pm	מנחה
6:55/8:11 pm	הדלקה (Early/Late)
8:29 pm	שקיעה
7:15 am	שחרית
8:30 pm	שקיעה
9:21 pm	מעריב (52)

Parshah-ly Punny!

Riddle: Why were the Israelites punished for demanding meat instead of Manna?

Answer: Because their complaining was a clear case of fowl play!



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משל ונמשל ב-Al תאמין?

By Reb Gemini

Consider the following "Torah" thought, generated by Gemini: Did the AI get it right? Do you find it to be accurate? Or did the technology miss the boat?

Mashal: Imagine a yungerman who has been sitting and learning b'hasmadah for years, subsisting on a steady diet of lukewarm coffee and leftover kiddush crackers. One day, a prominent gevir decides to reward him and flies him out, all expenses paid, to an ultra-luxurious, mehadrin min hamehadrin resort in the Swiss Alps. The gevir hires a world-renowned private chef who utilizes molecular gastronomy to prepare magnificent seudos tailored precisely to the yungerman's exact palate. Every single dish is an absolute masterpiece, an exquisite culinary triumph. For the first two days, the yungerman is in heaven. But by Wednesday afternoon, the gevir receives a highly agitated phone call. The yungerman is complaining bitterly. "What's the matter?" the gevir asks, terrified that a kashrus issue arose. "It's a disaster," the yungerman sighs. "The chef can make me a prime rib that melts in my mouth, but he doesn't have that fluorescent yellow jalapeño dip from the Thursday night mishmar, and I haven't seen a single slice of soggy potato kugel since I got here. I'm starving!" The gevir sits there bewildered; this young man is standing at the absolute pinnacle of luxury, consuming a daily feast of unimaginable quality, yet he is shedding real tears because he misses the heavy, cheap junk food of his regular grind back home.

Nimshal: This somewhat ridiculous scenario is exactly what unfolds in Parshas Behaaloscha with the tragic saga of the Manna and the Kivros Hataavah. Bnei Yisrael were receiving daily deliveries of lechem min hashamayim, a miraculous food that the Gemara (Yoma 75a) famously describes as having the ability to taste like absolutely any delicacy a person could possibly imagine, while being completely absorbed by their limbs without generating any waste whatsoever. It was the ultimate spiritual superfood. Yet, the Torah (Bamidbar 11:5-6) records the Asafsuf and the rest of the nation suddenly crying out, "Zacharnu es hadagah asher nochal b'Mitzrayim chinam, es hakishuim v'es ha'avatichim... v'atah nafsheinu yeveshah, ein kol bilti el hamann eineinu." Rashi (Bamidbar 11:5) points out that the word "chinam" does not mean the Egyptians were handing out free fish—nobody in Mitzrayim was running a philanthropic sushi gemach for Jewish slaves. Rather, "chinam" means they missed being free from the yoke of mitzvos. The Kli Yakar (Bamidbar 11:6) explains profoundly that the Manna was deeply spiritual sustenance, and because it lacked a heavy, coarse, physical byproduct, the complainers felt empty. They looked at the Manna—a direct miracle from the Ribono Shel Olam—and complained their souls were "dry." They literally possessed food that could taste like the greatest delicacies, but because it required constant emunah and lacked the dense, lethargic heaviness of Egyptian watermelons and garlic, they started a massive revolt. They traded a pristine, heavenly existence for the pathetic memory of a spicy garlic dip.

Practical Takeaway: The practical takeaway for every single one of us is that we constantly fall into the exact same trap of looking at our ruchniyus through the distorted lens of our craving for gashmiyus. We are incredibly privileged to live in a generation surrounded by the Manna of endless Torah opportunities—whether it is a beautifully delivered daf yomi shiur, a vibrant Beis Midrash, or the pure zechus of davening with a real bren. Yet, how often do we sit down to learn a blatt Gemara and immediately start checking our watches, complaining internally that it feels too "dry," wondering when the shul is going to host another massive fleishig event with three types of carving stations? The Mesillas Yesharim (Perek 1) writes that man was created solely to delight in Hashem, and this world is merely a corridor. When we find our Torah and tefillah boring, it is not because the Torah lacks flavor; it is because our spiritual palates have been completely deadened by the heavy, materialistic watermelons and garlic of the secular world around us. We must recognize the Manna in front of us for the absolute miracle that it is. Instead of demanding that our avodas Hashem constantly entertain us with loud gimmicks and heavy physical rewards, we need to cultivate a genuine appreciation for the pure, unadulterated sweetness of the Torah itself, realizing that true satisfaction comes from the spiritual reality, not the jalapeño dip.

GOOD SHABBUS!